REIMAGINING GOA



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Hon'ble Chief Minister, Goa

A new tourism vision is taking shape–one that looks beyond the coastline to culture, community, sustainability and experiences that reveal the many sides of Goa

Q. In the public perception, Goa is seen as the land of sun, sea, and beaches. However, the state Government plans to expand its tourism sector beyond this. What are its plans for spiritual, experiential, heritage, sports, and hinterland tourism?

Goa has surpassed its traditional image defined by the three S's: Sun, Sand and Sea. Though it has been our consistent message showcasing Goa's rich cultural, natural heritage, our key priorities now also include hinterland as well as Spiritual Tourism.

We are encouraging visitors to explore Goa's villages, waterfalls, forests, spice plantations, rivers, local cuisine and traditional festivals. This gives tourists a more authentic Goan experience while creating new livelihood opportunities for people living in rural areas. Our vision is to make tourism more sustainable and ensure that local communities become active partners in its growth.

We are also strengthening spiritual and heritage tourism through projects like the **Koti Tirtha Corridor, Shri Saptakoteshwar Temple**, while promoting Goa's temples, churches, forts and heritage precincts. These initiatives will help visitors discover Goa's rich history, faith and cultural traditions beyond its coastline.

Sports tourism is another area where Goa has established a strong identity. We have world-class infrastructure for football, cricket and water sports, and today Goa is successfully hosting national and international sporting events throughout the year. In the last few years alone, our State has proudly hosted the 37th National Games, the FIDE Chess World Cup, the World Table Tennis Star Contender, the 14th Acrobatic Gymnastics Asian Championships, Ironman India hosted annually since 2019 and the World Legends Pro T20 League. These prestigious events have strengthened Goa's position as one of India's leading sporting destinations.

We have also introduced the **Goa Wellness, Ayurveda and Yoga Policy 2026** to promote wellness tourism and position Goa as a destination for holistic health and well-being.

Our objective is clear: to increase the average length of stay, encourage visitors to explore different parts of Goa throughout the year, and build a regenerative tourism model that is sustainable, experience-driven and beneficial to local communities.

Q. Goa has initiatives on the cards like a homestay policy. What else does it have in mind to ensure the participation of local communities and women in the tourism sector? Does the Government plan to launch new schemes for skill development, local entrepreneurship, or introduce any rules making it mandatory for Goa-domiciled candidates to be hired in the tourism and hospitality sector?

For tourism to be truly successful, its benefits must reach the people of Goa. That is the thinking behind our proposed **Homestay Policy,** which will enable Goan families to participate directly in the tourism economy while giving visitors an authentic local experience.

We are promoting village tourism, hinterland experiences, local cuisine, handicrafts, cultural festivals and nature-based tourism so that local entrepreneurs, artisans, farmers, boat operators and women's Self-Help Groups become active stakeholders in the sector. Tourism should not be limited to a few destinations; it should strengthen the economy across Goa.

ATAL SETU - Enhancing connectivity between North Goa & South Goa



Skill development is central to this vision. On **World Youth Skill Day,** we signed **five MoUs** with leading industry and institutional partners to strengthen vocational education, practical training and employment opportunities for our youth. As I have often said, "Skilling, Reskilling and Upskilling must become a continuous process to prepare our youth for the opportunities of tomorrow."

I was particularly encouraged to see the innovative electric vehicles developed by students of our ITIs, which reflect the quality of technical education and the talent of our youth. Today, Goa is the **only state in the country with 100 per cent ISO-certified ITIs**. Through the **Goa Skills Mission, the Chief Minister's Apprenticeship Scheme,** and specialised training in hospitality, tourism and allied sectors, we are preparing young Goans for the jobs of the future.

We are also organising **Mega Job Fairs,** bringing employers and job seekers together on one platform and creating direct employment opportunities across sectors, including tourism and hospitality. Alongside employment, we are encouraging entrepreneurship so that more Goans become job creators rather than job seekers.

As far as mandatory hiring of Goa-domiciled candidates is concerned, there is no proposal to make it compulsory. Our focus is on creating a highly skilled local workforce so that Goans become the first choice for employers. By investing in skills, entrepreneurship and community participation, we want tourism to become a powerful driver of inclusive and sustainable growth for the people of Goa.

Q. Goa has two international airports at Dabolim and Mopa, but tourists find last-mile connectivity to be a problem. The lack of a metered or a fully-functional app-based taxi service is seen as a problem by tourists. Parking and traffic congestion is also a problem in tourist areas and in cities like Panaji and Madgaon. How does the state plan to resolve it?

As Goa's tourism continues to grow, we recognise that transport and last-mile connectivity must keep pace. With two international airports now operational at **Dabolim** and **Manohar International Airport,** our focus is on making travel within Goa more convenient, reliable and visitor-friendly.

On the taxi front, we have already introduced online solution with apps like the **Goa Miles, Goa Taxi App** to bring greater transparency and convenience to the sector. I am happy to say that nearly **50 per cent of**